external, surrounding and invading. This chapter argues that contemporary objects of violence are being defined in religious terms, as part of a threat being situated globally. Careful comparisons need to be made to other times in Burma when people who were subjected to violence were also Muslim. Such a comparison may underscore the shift described by Renaud Egreteau (2011), from an *Indo*phobia in the colonial era to an *Islamo*phobia later. It may also indicate a limit to "Islamophobia" as a lens for understanding Buddhist–Muslim violence. Contemporary arguments and affects may be about a global Islam, but this may also suggest that they are less about Islam than they are about the place of Myanmar in the world. This, in turn, may suggest an answer to a question raised by Tharaphi Than in her recent comparison of nationalism articulated near the end of British rule and that of contemporary movements. "It is perhaps easier to understand why Ba Cho advocated nationalism to fight against the British imperialism," she wrote, "than why Ma-Ba-Tha perceives the nation is under the threat of what they term as 'those who hold wrong beliefs,' especially during the seemingly peaceful time under one's own Buddhist-Burman government" (Tharaphi Than 2015, p. 16). This chapter does not explain the *motivations* of groups like MaBaTha, but it does highlight the way they are (re)defining a threat at a time when British imperialism is no longer the target.

Second, noting uses of international strands of argument also underscores the way anti-Muslim sentiments are being actively constructed. Reprising Croce and Gramsci, perhaps, history is always contemporary (Kahn 2002, p. 126) — and so is violence. There are many factors helping to lend contemporary anti-Muslim narratives their animating power, which this chapter does not explore. But these narratives are being actively constructed, re-constructed, and contested. This is certainly the case when people seek to reconcile contradictions between their personal friendships and memories that cross or blur religious lines. Conversations in western Yangon, for example, have been at times disturbing or saddening, but at others they have just felt like people seeking to make sense of global events and feelings of vulnerability that are still open and unclear. One way I have heard this accomplished is by friends and neighbours who draw a dividing line between the present and past, marking off remembered times of inter-religious harmony as occurring prior to a recently risen spectre of Islamic terrorism. In this telling, this spectre — presented as a global plot — makes it possible to both have had a lifetime of inter-religious relationships and a new sense of fear that helps repudiate them.